Two Indian Army soldiers, one armed with a Kalashnikov-series assault rifle and the other with the 1A LMG, are pictured during an exchange of fire with Kashmiri militants in the village of Harran, near Srinagar, 2 February 1999. (MUSTAFA TAUSEEF/AFP via Getty Images)



Indian artillerymen fire their 105mm Indian Field Gun, Kargil sector, 31 May 1999. This highly mobile artillery piece was developed in India and produced from 1978. Note the various camouflage patterns being worn by the crew members. ARKO DATTA/AFP via Getty Images)

The Pakistan Army had selected the Kargil sector for its operation that had the Srinagar–Kargil–Leh National Highway 1A (NH-1A) winding through it. The area has an approximately 160km-long stretch of ridges overlooking the NH-1A and is marked by high mountains, with jagged,